

SOYEON JEON

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis

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EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis (WashU), MO, USA

Ph.D. in Political Science

2028 (*expected*)

Committee: **Jacob Montgomery**, Taylor Carlson, Christopher Lucas, Betsy Sinclair

M.A. in Political Science

2025

A.M. in Statistics and Data Science

Seoul National University (SNU), Seoul, South Korea

M.A. Coursework in Political Science and International Relations

2019-2022

B.B.A. in Business Administration

2019

B.A. in Political Economy and Philosophy

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Citizens’ attitudes toward democracy, institutional backsliding, and AI governance
- Bias in multimodal AI systems and AI-assisted measurement for political science

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Soyeon Jeon**, Messi H.J. Lee, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Calvin K. Lai. 2026. “From Faces to Politics: Vision-Language Models (Sometimes) Link Visual Demographic Characteristics to Ideological Labels.” *Political Analysis*.

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Soyeon Jeon**. “Transforming Political Image Analysis: Vision Language Models as Accessible, Efficient, and High-Performing Tools.” *R&R at Political Analysis*.
2. Cecilia Y. Sui, **Soyeon Jeon**, Christopher Lucas, Jacob Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. “Cross-Lingual Transfer for Political Text Analysis: Detecting Populist Rhetoric Across Languages Using Single-Language Fine-Tuning.”
3. **Soyeon Jeon** and Do Won Kim. “Multimodal NLP for Perspective Analysis in Korean Presidential TV Debates.”

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. **Soyeon Jeon**. “Understanding Democratic Norms and Citizen Commitment.” (*Job Market Paper*)
2. **Soyeon Jeon** and Jacob M. Montgomery. “Public Acceptance of AI Decision Systems.”
3. Messi H.J. Lee, **Soyeon Jeon**, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Calvin K. Lai. “Prototypicality Bias in Vision-Language Models.”

PREPRINTS

1. Messi H.J. Lee, **Soyeon Jeon**, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Calvin K. Lai. 2025. “Visual Cues of Gender and Race are Associated with Stereotyping in Vision-Language Models.” arXiv preprint arXiv:2503.05093.

2. Messi H.J. Lee and **Soyeon Jeon**. 2025. “Token Sampling Uncertainty Does Not Explain Homogeneity Bias in Large Language Models.” arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.19337.
3. Messi H.J. Lee and **Soyeon Jeon**. 2024. “Vision-Language Models Generate More Homogeneous Stories for Phenotypically Black Individuals.” arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.09668.

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

– McDonnell International Scholarship, WashU	<i>2022 – 2027 (Tuition & stipend)</i>
– Graduate Research Seed Grant (\$550)	<i>2026</i>
– Institute for Humane Studies Research Grant No. IHS020655 (\$3,000)	<i>2026</i>
– PolMeth Travel Award	<i>2022, 2025</i>
– LSQ Research Grant, WashU (\$5,000)	<i>2025</i>
– Third Year Paper Seed Grant, WashU (\$1,000)	<i>2024</i>
– APSA Travel Award	<i>2023</i>
– University Merit-based Scholarship	<i>2014, 2020</i>

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

– AI Upskilling for Social Scientists	<i>2026</i>
– Video Research Institute, Purdue University	<i>2026</i>
– CPAC: The Latest Trends in Political Communication and Rhetoric	<i>2026 (Panel)</i>
– APSA	<i>2025 (Panel)</i>
– PolMeth	<i>2022 (Poster), 2025 (Panel & Poster)</i>
– Summer Institute in Computational Social Science - Korea	<i>2022</i>

CIVIC ENGAGEMENTS AND OTHERS

– Deliberative Budget Citizens’ Assembly, Seoul Citizen Participatory Budgeting Program	<i>2020</i>
– Residents’ Autonomous Assembly, Gwanak-gu, Seoul	<i>2019</i>
– Special Commission on Social Disaster Investigation, Government	<i>2018</i>
– Asian Citizen’s Center for Environment and Health, NGO	<i>2018</i>
– Field Research on Korean Diaspora in Taiwan	<i>2016</i>
– Asleep, AI-Powered Sleep Tech Startup	<i>2020 – 2021</i>

INVITED TALKS

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| 1. Redesigning Democratic Discourse: AI Interventions for Civic Deliberation, SNU | <i>2026</i> |
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TEACHING

Instructor

Python Programming	<i>2025</i>
Lab for Quantitative Political Methodology I	<i>2025</i>
R Programming for Beginners	<i>2024, 2025</i>

Co-Instructor

Seminar in Contemporary Political Science: AI-Mediated Civic Deliberation Capstone	<i>2026</i>
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Teaching Assistant

<i>Graduate</i>	
Quantitative Political Methodology I	<i>2025</i>

Research Methods in Political Science	2021
Public Choice Theory Practice	2020
Global Civil Society and Global Governance	2019

Undergraduate

AI, You, and Now: The Stories That Win	2026
Data Science for Politics	2025
Global Leaders Program: Election System in Korea	2022
Student Directed Education: Value Inquiry	2021
Understanding Modern Politics of South and North Korea	2021
Student Directed Education: Undergraduate Independent Study 1	2021
Principles of Political Science	2021
Selected Topics Seminar 3: Globalization and Media	2021
Game Theory and Politics	2020
Civil Politics	2019

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

WashU

Populist Rhetoric on Social Media and Its Effects on Democracies (NSF Grant 2215008)	2023 – 2024
Reimagining Multilateralism and U.S. Foreign Policy (Carnegie Grant G-23-600440)	2023 – 2024
Interpersonal Pathways to Radicalization & Deradicalization (NSF Grant 0029220)	2021

SNU

Korean Voter in the Age of Deepfake (National Research Foundation of Korea)	2022
Peace Studies Research Project (Humanities Korea)	2020 – 2022
Detecting Manipulation in Election Results Using Machine Learning (NRF Korea)	2021
Scholarly Content Review (Social Sciences Korea)	2020
Editor in Chief, <i>Civil Society Research</i> (Center for Social Innovation, SNU)	2019 – 2020
Seoul Community Support Centre Project	2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Reviewer, *ACM Transactions on Asian and Low-Resource Language Information Processing*
- Reviewer, *Information, Communication & Society*

BOOK CHAPTER

1. **Jeon, Soyeon** and Jinwoo Lee. “Realization of People’s Sovereignty through NGOs: Based on the Observation of Participation in the Asian Citizen’s Center for Environment and Health.” In Kim, Eui Young and Lee, Hyun Jung (eds.), *Cultural and Technical Journal of Citizen Politics*. Seoul: Purungil, 2019.

EDITED BOOKS

1. Kim, Eui Young and Miura, Hiroki (eds.). *2019 Civil Politics Yearbook*. Seoul: Purungil, 2019. (Selected as Sejong Book.) *Editor in chief*.
2. Kim, Eui Young and Miura, Hiroki (eds.). *2020 Civil Politics Yearbook*. Seoul: Purungil, 2021. *Editor*.
3. Center for Social Innovation Education & Research (eds.). *Campus Impact 2020*. Seoul: Purungil, 2021. *Editor*.